

THE COUNCIL FOR TOBACCO RESEARCH - U. S. A.

Dr. T. C. Tso
U. S. Department of Agriculture

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that such smoke really functions in humans as a direct chemical carcinogen. Hence we have not felt that major efforts to reduce further the infinitesimal levels of polynuclear hydrocarbons in smoke were likely to be productive of any real benefits. If others, however, wish to try removing, diminishing or neutralizing the possible effects of such substances on the basis of what they believe to be justifiable assumptions, and provided that any modifications proposed can be shown clearly to produce no other change potentially deleterious to health, we could not disapprove. At present the limitations of our bioassay methods make such assurance difficult. We could give other illustrations in addition to this discussion of possible carcinogenicity, such, for example as ciliostasis, but the general perspective is much the same.

You will be able to apply the general statements that we have made, to the specific cases of the components suggested in your list as candidates for analytical study in tobacco leaf samples. We would applaud the acquisition of information on all these ingredients as additions to the stock-pile of knowledge that should eventually be useful in one manner or another. But there is no possible assurance at present that any of these will ever turn out to be significantly related to health problems.

In the special case of additives to cigarette tobacco, we have felt that these were quite unlikely to bear any relation to the health picture. The reason for this feeling is that no such additives are used in Britain where the incidence of diseases held to be related statistically to cigarette smoking is, nevertheless, much higher than in the United States.

The Council will be glad to be kept in touch with the program of the U. S. Department of Agriculture and the National Cancer Institute by correspondence and by personal contact. In turn we shall be glad to furnish those agencies with any desired data or information from our own program either now or in the future.

Sincerely,

CC Little

Dr. Clarence Cook Little
The Scientific Director

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Enclosure

cc: Dr. B. T. Shaw - U. S. Department of Agriculture

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